

ALIREZA SALKHORDEH ZIABARI

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RESEARCH INTEREST

Natural Language Processing (NLP), Reinforcement Learning (RL), Large Language Models (LLMs), Alignment.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Computer Science, University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA, U.S. 2021 - Expected 2026

PI: **Morteza Dehghani** [Member of Morality and Language Lab](#)

Thesis Title: **Adaptive Reasoning in Large Language Models**: From Instance Selection to Reasoning Styles

M.Sc. in Computer Science, University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA, U.S. 2021 - 2024

Related Courses: Advanced Natural Language Processing, Dynamics Of Representation Learning, Advanced Analysis of Algorithms, Multi-level Modeling, Linear System Theory, Random Processes, Probability and Statistics.

B.Sc. in Computer Engineering, Sharif University of Technology, Tehran, Iran. 2016 - 2020

PI: **Mohammad Hossein Rohban**, GPA: 3.74/4

PUBLICATIONS

- [1] Rahmati, E.*, **Ziabari, A.***, Dehghani, M. [CoCo-CoLa: Evaluating Language Adherence in Multilingual LLMs](#) — MRL at EMNLP 2025.
- [2] Abdurahman, S., **Ziabari, A.**, Moore, D. A., Bartels, D., Dehghani, M. [Evaluating large language models in psychological research: A guide for reviewers](#) - AMPPS.
- [3] Golazizian, P., **Ziabari, A.**, Omrani, A., Dehghani, M. [Cost-Efficient Subjective Task Annotation and Modeling through Few-Shot Annotator Adaptation](#) — EMNLP 2024.
- [4] Hejabi P., Rahmati E., **Ziabari, A.**, Golazizian, P., Thomason, J., Dehghani, M. [Evaluating Creativity and Deception in Large Language Models: A Simulation Framework for Multi-Agent Balderdash](#) — Wordplay at ACL 2024.
- [5] **Ziabari, A.**, Omrani, A., Hejabi, P., Golazizian, P., Kennedy, B., Piray, P., Dehghani, M. [Reinforced Multiple Instance Selection for Speaker Attribute Prediction](#) — NAACL 2024.
- [6] Omrani, A.*, **Ziabari, A.***, Golazizian, P., Sorensen, J., Dehghani, M. [Towards a Unified Framework for Adaptable Problematic Content Detection via Continual Learning](#) — WOAHH at NAACL 2024.
- [7] Omrani, A., **Ziabari, A.**, Yu, C., Golazizian, P., Kennedy, B., Atari, M., Ji, Heng., Dehghani, M. (2023) [Social-Group-Agnostic Bias Mitigation via the Stereotype Content Model](#) — ACL 2023, Nominated for Best Paper Award (1.6% of accepted papers).

IN PREPARATION & UNDER REVIEW

- [1] [The Homogenizing Effect of Large Language Models on Human Expression and Thought](#) - R&R, TiCS.
- [2] [Reasoning on a Spectrum: Aligning LLMs to System 1 and System 2 Thinking](#) - Under review at ICLR 2025.
- [3] [The Shrinking Landscape of Linguistic Diversity in the Age of Large Language Models](#) - R&R, Nature Human Behavior.
- [4] [What Doesn't Kill Us: Harsh Ecologies Beget Difficulty-as-Improvement Norms](#).
- [5] [The Moral Foundations Reddit Corpus](#).

WORK & RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- Machine Learning Research Intern at [Netflix](#)

May. 2025 - Aug. 2025

 - Designed and led a research project on studying Personalized LLM-as-a-judge for recommendation evaluation.
 - Implemented SFT, DPO, and GRPO for improving the LLM by adding reasoning capabilities.
- Research Assistant at University of Southern California

May. 2022 - Present

 - PI: Morteza Dehghani. Member of Morality and Language lab.
 - Conduct research on continual learning and bias mitigation, applying RL for adaptive reasoning; actively investigate contrastive learning in GRPO and entropy-based model selection.
- Research Assistant at University of Southern California

May. 2021 - May. 2022

 - PI: Maryam Shanechi. Member of Neural Systems Engineering and Information Processing Lab.
 - Designed a self-supervised transformer model for mood classification on the brain signals.
- Machine Learning Engineer at [Tapsi](#)

Oct. 2020 - May. 2021

 - Led online traffic estimation projects, improving to 5% average ETA compared to Google Maps and Waze.
 - Deployed a time-series autoencoder pipeline to estimate online traffic using drivers' locations with Pytorch.
- Machine Learning Intern at [Fanap Advanced Technology Lab \(Zlab\)](#)

July. 2020 - Oct. 2020

 - Built Object Detection tool, which led to intelligent grocery store carts.
 - Maintained a dataset and trained a Yolo-v5 with Tensorflow.
- Research Assistant at Sharif University of Technology

Sept. 2018 - Aug. 2020

 - PI: Mohammad Hossein Rohban. Member of Robust and Interpretable Machine Learning Lab.
 - Developed a Meta-Learning algorithm for anomaly detection in images using Pytorch as my bachelor's thesis.

SELECTED SKILLS

Programming Language: Python, SQL, R, Java, C++, C, MatLab, bash.
Software: Pytorch, Tensorflow, Keras, Transformers, TRL, Verl, torchtune, pySpark, Pandas, Numpy.
Statistics: Multi-level Modeling
Languages: English, Persian

HONORS & AWARDS

Best Poster Award, Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP)	2023
Ranked 9th among Computer Engineering Students in Sharif University of Technology.	2020
Ranked 213th among over 200,000 participants in the Nationwide University Entrance Exam.	2016
Member of the National Organization for Development of Exceptional Talents.	2009

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

- Teaching Assistant at University of Southern California

2024 - Presents

 - Graduate Courses: Information Retrieval and Search Engine (Fall 2024, Fall 2025), Analysis of Algorithm (Spring 2025).
- Teaching Assistant at Sharif University of Technology

2017 - 2020

 - Graduate Courses: Deep Learning (Spring 2020, Fall 2019).
 - Artificial Intelligence(Spring 2020, Fall 2019), Database Design(Spring 2019), Probability and Statistics(Fall 2018), Advance Programming (Spring 2017).